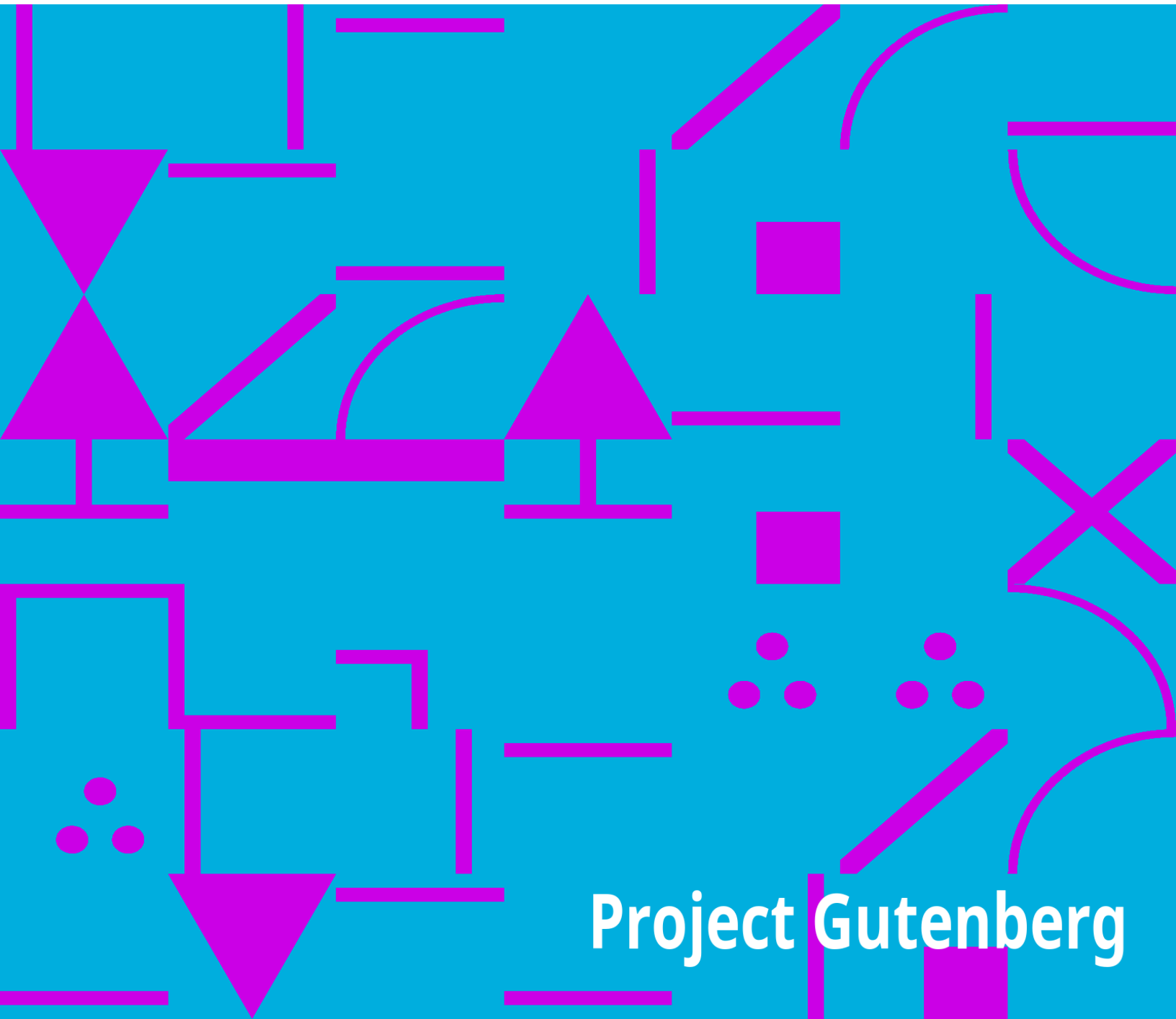


The Nursery, January 1881, Vol. XXIX

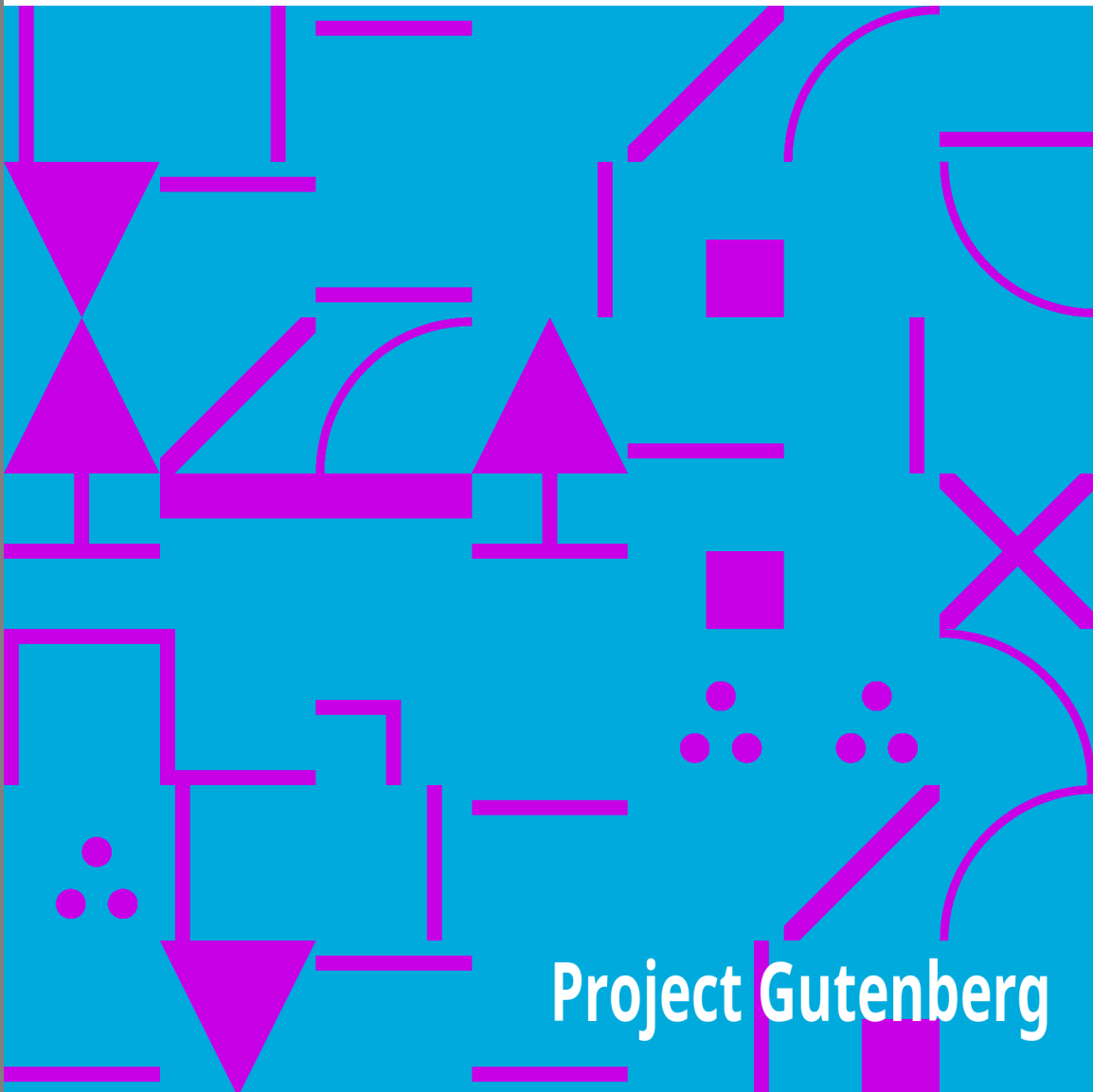
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Title: The Nursery, January 1881, Vol. XXIX

Author: Various

Release date: September 14, 2012 [eBook #40752]

Language: English

Other information and formats: www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/40752

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JANUARY 1881, VOL. XXIX ***



THE NURSERY

A Monthly Magazine
FOR YOUNGEST READERS.

VOLUME XXIX.—No. 1.

BOSTON:
THE NURSERY PUBLISHING COMPANY,
No. 36 BROMFIELD STREET.
1881.



Entered according to act of Congress, in the year 1881, by
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THAT MERRY CHRISTMAS.



THAT MERRY CHRISTMAS



HAT a glad noise there was that Christmas morning! The children had got up early to look in their stockings. John's were not quite large enough to hold all of his gifts. It is rather hard to crowd a sword, a gun, and a rocking-horse all into one stocking.

Mary had a fine new doll. Harry had a box, and, on taking off the cover, up sprang a wise-looking little man, with a cap on his head. Jessy had a doll, and a very pretty one it was too. Tommy had a what-do-you-call-it. Why did he look up the chimney? I think it was to see if there was any sign of Santa Claus.

John mounted his horse, waved his sword, and held up his gun. But very soon he began to get tired of them all. The thought came into his head that he was more than eight years old. "What do I want of these toys?" said he. "Why was I so silly as to choose them, when aunt Susan would have given me a microscope?" And John laid down his sword and gun, feeling quite above such childish things.

When aunt Susan came, she saw that John did not seem as glad over his presents as the rest of the children did over theirs. "What is the matter, John?" she asked. "Why are you not playing with your toys?"

"Aunt Susan," said John, "I wish I had taken the microscope. Is it too late?"

"No, John. I thought you might repent your choice, so I said to Mr. Grover, who keeps the toy-shop, 'I think I shall want to change the microscope: can I do so?' He said, 'Yes.' His shop will be open till eleven o'clock. So run round and get the microscope, and tell him to send tomorrow and take back the toys."

In five seconds John had on his hat, and was running down the street to Mr. Grover's. He came back with the microscope in about half an hour, and was full of joy at the change. A merry Christmas it was then for all the children!

UNCLE CHARLES.



BABY'S QUIET FAMILY.

WHENEVER I walk
With my children three,
I laugh and I talk
For the whole family.

There's Ruth (her arm's broken!)
And Jane and Annette,
They never have spoken
Or laughed even, yet;

But I know when they're glad,—
Mothers always can tell,—
And I'm sad when they're sad,
For I love them so well!

Whenever we walk,
Though they're still as can be,
I can easily talk
Quite enough for the three.

W. G.



BABY AND THE BIRD.



BABY is looking out of the window. Jane is holding him up so that he will not fall out. What does he see that makes him jump up and down with joy?

He sees a dear little bird. It has come for its daily meal of seed and crumbs. It is not afraid of baby? Why should it be? How could any bird be afraid of such a dear child?

When the bird has had its dinner, I think it will sing.

A. B. C.



A NEW YEAR'S DIALOGUE.

HARRY.

LOUD from the north the wild wind blows;
It sweeps the blue sky clear,
And parts, amid the drifting snows,
The path of the New Year;
The glad New Year that always brings
So many bright delightful things,
Gay holidays and merry plays,
And loving wishes from our friends.
A "Happy New Year" let us make,
And keep it "happy" till it ends,
By trying every day to see
What good, good children we can be.

KATE.

Last year, when any thing went wrong,
I used to fret the whole day long,
And sometimes sob and cry aloud,
Dark-looking as a thunder-cloud;
But, even in a gloomy place,
I now must keep a sunny face;
For, all this year, I mean to see
How bright and cheerful I can be.

MARY.

Last year, the flitting butterfly
Was not so idle as was I;
I liked my sports and frolic well,
But would not learn to read and spell:
Now I must change my ways at once,
Or I shall surely be a dunce.

This glad New Year that has begun,
Must leave me wiser when 'tis done.

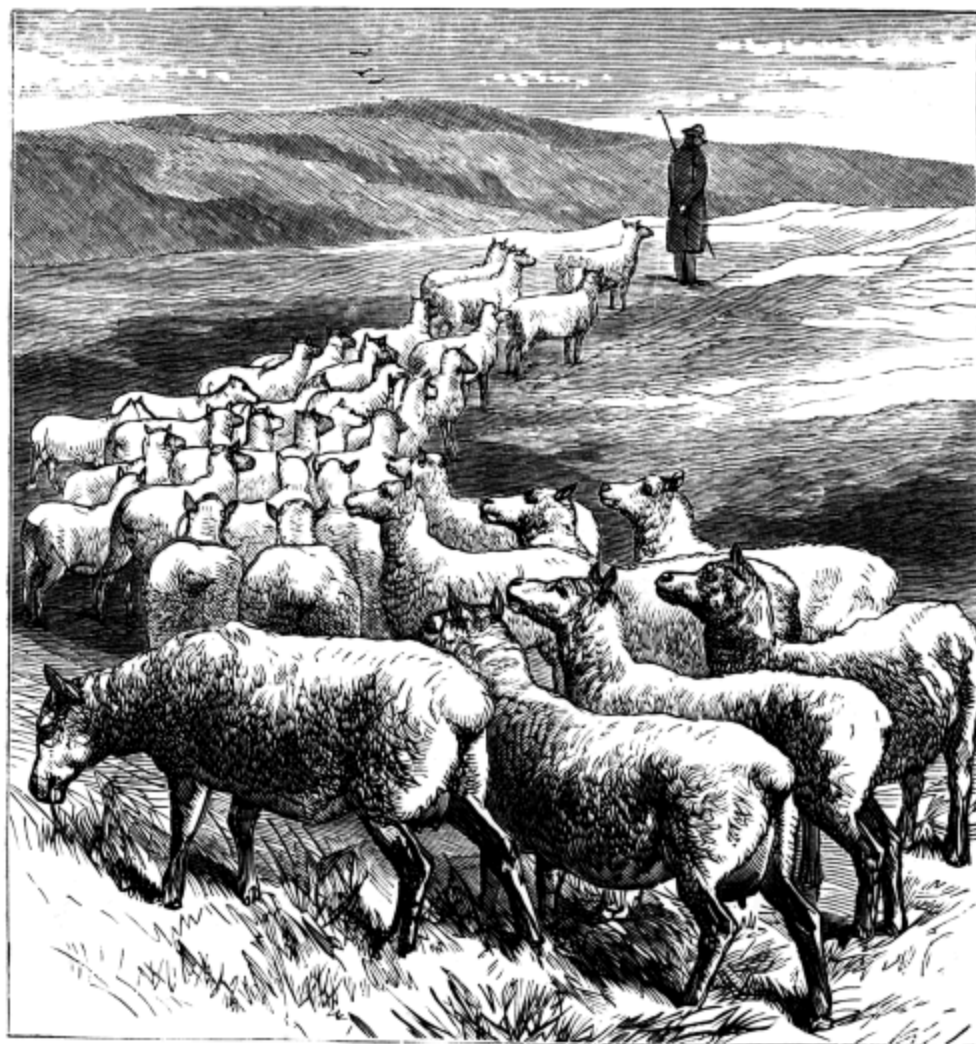
JAMES.

Last year, my temper was so quick,
My angry words came fast and thick,
And brother Tom I'd scold and strike
When he did what I did not like.
I am so sorry! Loving words
Are sweeter than the song of birds;
And, all this year, I mean to see
If I a gentle child can be.

ALL. (*Four or more.*)

The past is past; the year is new:
We will be patient, brave, and true;
When we are bidden, quick to mind;
Unselfish, courteous, and kind;
And try in every place to see
What good, good children we can be.
MARIAN DOUGLAS.





THE SHEEP FOLLOW THE SHEPHERD.



HE tenth chapter of St. John says, "He calleth his own sheep by name, and leadeth them out. He goeth before them, and the sheep follow him; for they know his voice. And a stranger will they not follow, but will flee from him; for they know not the voice of strangers."

But may it not be the form or dress of the shepherd that the sheep know, and follow him? To test this, a traveller, who had put the question, once exchanged dresses with a shepherd, and went amongst the sheep.

The traveller in the shepherd's dress called the sheep, and tried to lead them; but "they knew not his voice," and did not move. But when the shepherd called them, though he was in the traveller's dress, they ran at once to him, thus proving that it was the voice that led them.

I have a dog that will sometimes bark at me when I put on an overcoat which he has not seen me wear before. But, the moment he hears my voice, he seems ashamed of not having known me, and will whine, as if he would say, "Pardon me, good master. It was very stupid in me not to know you. It was your coat I did not know. I will try to be wiser the next time."

DORA BURNSIDE.



"A FRIEND IN NEED."



HENRY lived in the great city of London. He was known as "the boy at the crossing." He used to sweep one of the crossings in Oxford Street. In wet weather these crossings are very muddy. Now and then some one would give him a penny for his work.

He did not make much in a day; but what he got was a great help to his mother. That thought kept him daily at his work. One day he saw a little girl trying to lead her little brother across the street. The carts and the horses made her afraid, and she ran back timidly.

"What's the matter, little girl?" asked Henry.

"I am afraid we shall be run over," said the girl.

"I'll help you across," said Henry. Then, lifting the little boy in his arms, he took the girl by the hand, and led her safely to the other side of the street.



"Thank you!" said the little girl; and "Thank you!" said her little brother, as plainly as he could speak it.

I went up and asked the boy with the broom if he knew the children. "I never saw them before in my life," said he; "but such little ones can't get across without help."

"You are a good boy," said I. "I think you must have a good father."

"I had one once," said he; "but now I have only a good mother."

"Well, Henry," said I, "give her this shilling, and tell her I send it to her for teaching her boy to do good when he can get a chance."

Tears came to the boy's eyes. A shilling seemed a good deal of money to him, and it pleased him all the more because it was given him for his mother.

"Thank you, sir; thank you!" said he, and he ran back to his work one of the happiest boys in London, I think, at that moment.

JANE OLIVER.



"IN A MINUTE."



If you asked Dora to do any thing, she would reply, "In a minute." It was a bad habit she had. "Dora, please bring me a drink of water."—"In a minute."—"Dora, go up stairs, and bring me down my comb."—"Yes, mother, in a minute."—"Dora, come to your dinner."—"In a minute."

One day the bird was hopping about on the floor. Somebody went out, leaving the door open, just as "somebody" is always doing. Dora's mother said, "Dora, shut the door, or the cat will be after your bird."

"Yes, mother, in a minute," said Dora. "I just want to finish this line in my drawing." But the cat did not wait till this was done. In he popped, and with one dart he had the bird in his mouth.

Down went the slate on the floor, and away went cat, bird, and Dora. There was a wild chase on the lawn. "In a minute" Dora came back weeping, with the poor bird in her hand, but, oh! the life had all been shaken out of him.



How Dora cried! Mamma was sorry for her, but said, "A great many things may happen 'in a minute,' Dora. I hope the next time you are told to do a thing, you will do it at once."

MARY ADDISON.





The Christmas Tree

S
PR
IN
G

and Summer and russet Fall
Come and go with a varied cheer;
Each has something, and none has all,
Of the good things of the year.

Winter laughs, though the trees are
bare,
With a kindly laugh that is good to
see;
For of all the forest is none so rare
As his merry Christmas-tree.

It blooms with many a taper's flame;
And hidden under the leaves of
green

Are fruits of every shape and name,
The funniest ever seen,—



Book and bundle, and scarf, and shawl,
Picture and peanuts, skate and saw,
Candy and album, and bat and ball,
Hatchet, and doll, and taw,

Games and frames, and comical dames
With walnut faces wrinkled and old,

Fillets
rare
for the
sunny
hair,
And
jewels
of
pearl
and
gold.

For the
good
St.
Nichol
as
blest
this
tree,

And
it blooms and bears for every one,
With a gift of love to you and me,
For beauty, or use, or fun.

Poorer than any the Child whose name
Has given a name to our Christmas-
tree;
Yet kingly gifts to his cradle came,
And kingly gifts gave He.

GEORGE S. BURLEIGH.



DOWN THE RIVER AFTER THE BOY.



WALTER DALE was a little boy six years old, who lived with his parents on the bank of the River Thames in England. One day, after dinner, he went to the water's edge to play.

Seeing a small boat tied to a big stone by a rope, he pulled the boat up to the shore. "What a nice little boat!" said he. "I will get into it, and rock it, as I once saw a big boy do."

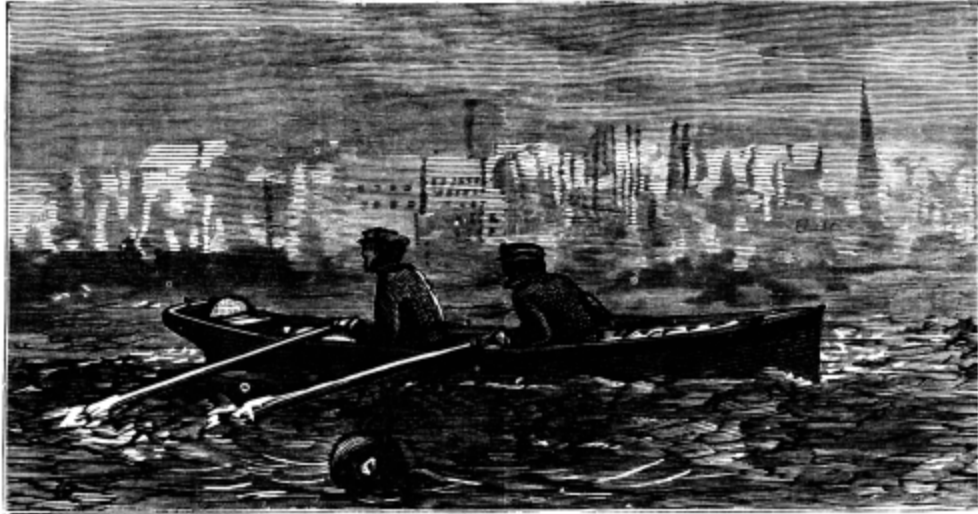
So he got into the boat, and began to rock it. The boat got loose, and drifted down the river. Walter did not notice this until he was quite a distance from the shore; then, turning round, he saw what had happened. Every moment the current was carrying him further from home.

Walter was not a timid boy, and, instead of crying, he began to reason in this way: "The boat does not leak. It is safe and sound. There are no waves to make me afraid. The wind does not blow. Here on a seat is a thick blanket. In this box is a loaf of bread and a knife. The water of the river is good to drink, and here is a tin mug. I think I will not cry, but hope for the best."

So he sat down. He called to some people on the shore; but they did not hear him. He stood up, and waved his hat to a man in a passing boat, and cried, "Help, help!" But the man thought it was some little fellow making fun of him.

Meanwhile Walter's mother had become anxious. She ran down to the river, and followed his foot-tracks to the edge of the water. Then she ran back to her husband; but he was not in the house. In about an hour he came back, and she said, "Quick, quick! Get a boat, and call John to help you. Walter is drifting down the river in that little green boat, I am sure."

Mr. Dale ran out of the house, called his man John, and they went down to the bank. Here they took a good fast boat, pulled it out into the stream, and began to row with the current.



It was getting late. A mist was creeping over the great city of London. They could hardly see the tall stores, the masts and steeples on one side. But on they went, rowing swiftly with their good oars, as if for dear life.

They looked out sharply on both sides to catch a sight of the little green boat. At last, when they had rowed about two miles, with the tide in their favor, Mr. Dale cried out, "I see it! I see it! But, ah! it is empty. I see no sign of a boy in it. What can have become of poor Walter?"

On they rowed, and at last came up with the boat. Still no Walter was to be seen. The poor father was in despair, when all at once Walter started up from under the great blanket, where he had been hiding. He cried out, "Here I am, papa, safe and sound!"

"Oh, you little rogue! Come here and let me pull your ears!" They all got back to their home in time for a late tea, which mother had kept warm for them. Walter was kissed and then cuffed; but the cuffs were so tender, that they made him laugh even more than the kisses.

ALFRED STETSON.



"FLUTTER, FLUTTER!"

FLUTTER, flutter, with never a stop,
All the leaves have begun to drop;
While the wind, with a skip and a hop,
Goes about gathering in his crop.

Flutter, flutter, on bustling wings,
All the plump little feathered things:
Thrush and bobolink, finch and jay,
Follow the sun on his holiday.

Flutter, flutter, the snowflakes all
Jostle each other in their fall,
Crowd and push into last year's nest,
And hide the seeds from robin-redbreast.

Flutter, flutter, the hours go by;
Nobody sees them as they fly;
Nobody hears their fairy tread,
Nor the rustle of their wings instead.

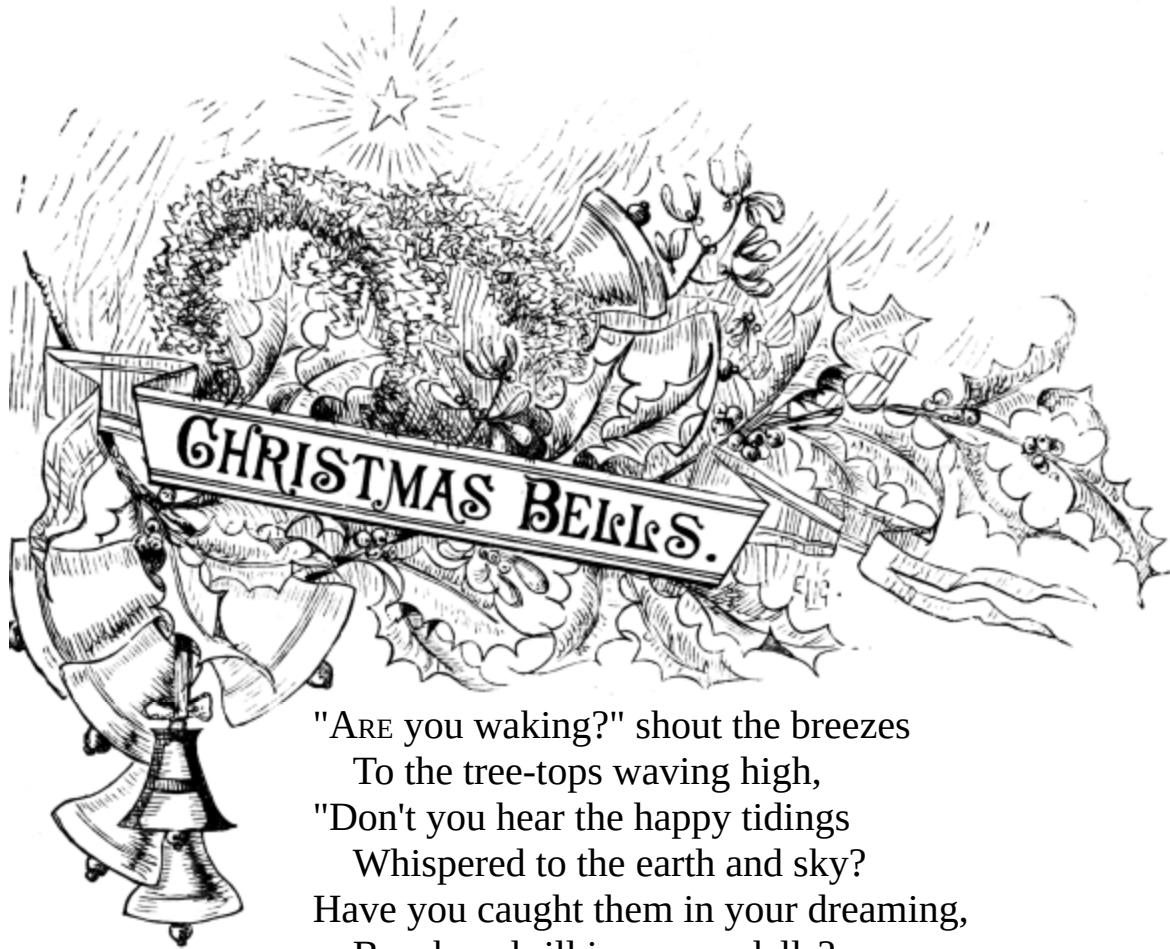
MARY N. PRESCOTT.





DRAWING-LESSON.
VOL. XXIX.—NO. 1.





"ARE you waking?" shout the breezes
To the tree-tops waving high,
"Don't you hear the happy tidings
Whispered to the earth and sky?
Have you caught them in your dreaming,
Brook and rill in snowy dells?
Do you know the joy we bring you
In the merry Christmas bells?
Ding, dong! ding, dong, Christmas bells!

"Are you waking, flowers that slumber
In the deep and frosty ground?
Do you hear what we are breathing
To the listening world around?
For we bear the sweetest story
That the glad year ever tells:
How He loved the little children,—
He who brought the Christmas bells!
Ding, dong! ding, dong, Christmas bells!"

GEORGE COOPER.



JACK THE MAGPIE.



ONE day last summer, a man in Colorado found a magpie by the roadside. Its wings had been clipped, so that it could not fly. The man gave it to a little boy named Ernest Hart.

He lived with his parents in a neat cottage near by a mountain stream. He ran home, and showed the bird to his sister Edith. They named it Jack.

Jack was quite a large bird. His body was black as coal; his breast was white; and his wings and tail shaded off into a dark green. His bill was long and very strong. He had a shrewd, knowing look. As he was quite tame, he must have been some one's pet.

He would hop and strut around in such a funny, pompous way, that one could not help laughing. He would take food from any one's hand, but would not let any one touch him, except Mr. Hart, the children's father.

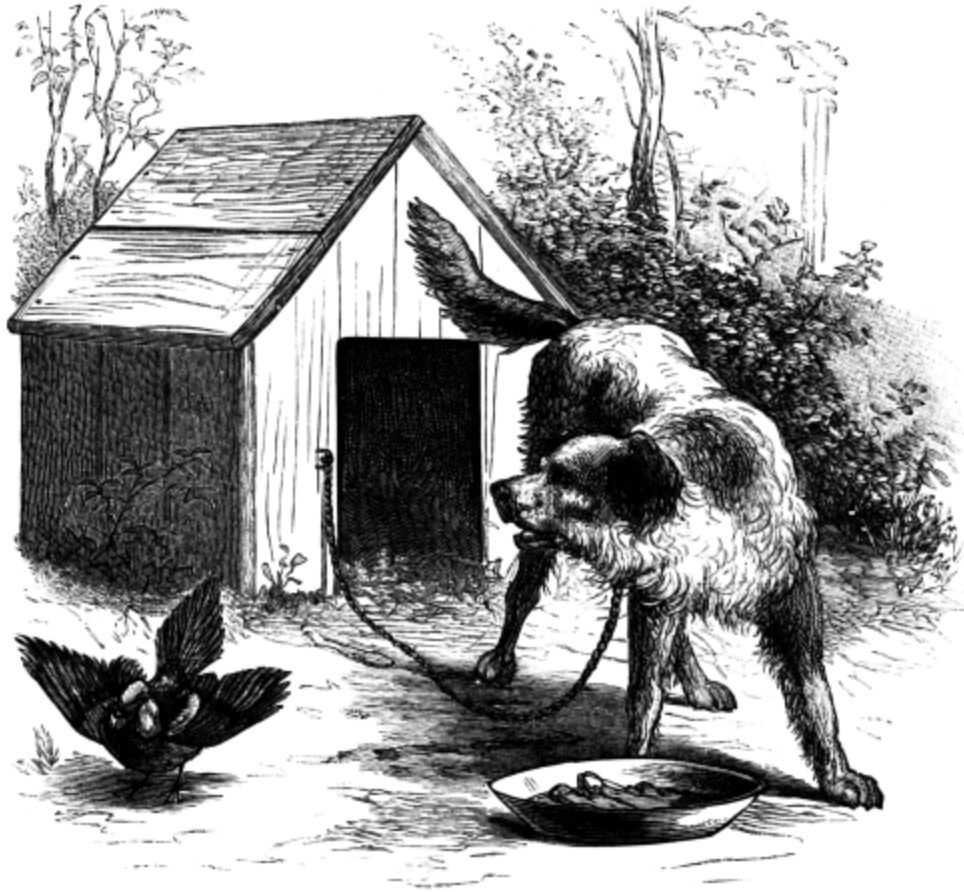
To Mr. Hart he seemed to take a great liking. He would hop on to his hand or shoulder: he would follow him all over the place. As soon as Mr. Hart came into the house, Jack would stand outside the door, and scream to him to come out. Indeed, Jack was almost too fond of him.

One day when Mr. Hart was chopping wood, Jack kept laying his bill within two or three inches of the place where the axe fell. It seemed just as if he wanted his bill chopped off.

Jack could talk a little. He could say "pretty," "what," and "yes, sir." When hungry, he would come round to the kitchen-door. There he would keep up a loud chattering, till food was given him to eat.

Jack was shy of Marcus, the dog. But, while Marcus was eating his dinner, Jack would steal up, and seize a bone from the plate. Then he would run off and hide it.

I believe that all magpies are thieves. I know that Jack was a sad thief. He would carry off almost any thing he saw lying about. One day he was caught in the act of carrying off the gardener's pipe.



It was fun for Ernest and Edith to watch him at his mischief. All summer they made much of him. Now, in October, though the trees are still green and the wild flowers are not gone, we have had in our Colorado home a taste of winter.

The ground has been white with snow. Jack is still with us, and seems quite happy. Edith and Ernest may stay here all winter. Perhaps I may tell you something of their winter sports. Would you like to hear it?

AUNT SADIE.



PORTRAITS FOR LITTLE FOLKS.

THIS is Master Baby,
Paying a morning call,
Sitting so good upon his chair,
But speaking not at all.
Listening to every word,
The funny little man!
Wondering at the news he hears,
Thinking all he can.



This little lady,
I'd have you know,
Is Miss Mary Vernon,
With cheeks in a glow.
She has a doll Bella,
Quite dear to her heart,
And takes her to ride
In a nice little cart.

This is Tommy Trip:
Bubbles he can blow;
When a bubble breaks too soon,
Tommy cries, "Don't go!"
Older folks I know,
Who their fine schemes make,
And, when any fine scheme fails,
Cry, "Oh, do not break!"



'Tis the winter cold,
All the ponds are ice;
Susan loves the winter cold,
Calls the weather nice.
Warm with muff and coat,
She can go and skate;
She can glide along the ice
At a merry rate.

This is Mary Jane,
See! she has a saucer:
To her cat she says,
"Give me up your paw, sir.
I've some fresh, nice milk
You will relish greatly."
Pussy then put up her paw;
All this happened lately.





This is Baby May:
She looks out to spy
If her own dear papa comes
On the road near by.
Yes, she sees him now,
He is coming fast;
For he loves his Baby May,
Loves her first and last.
K. G.





AMONG THE HOLLY-BUSHES.



AND who is this, looking out from amid the holly-bushes, this cold winter day? Whose sweet, merry, roguish face is this? She is wrapped up warm; she has gloves on her hands, and a nice thick hood on her head.

It is my niece Clara. She has been out with her brothers and the men to gather holly and evergreen for Christmas. First they cut down a little pine for the Christmas-tree. It was not so very little either; for it was twenty feet high.

There was snow on the ground, and they had a sledge on which to pile the hemlock-boughs, the evergreens, and the holly. Clara saw a squirrel run up a tree, and called to her brothers to look; but they were not quick enough to see it.

Then she spied a hollow place by the side of a hill, and going to look at it, she found it was a little pond of ice. It was smooth as glass, and she and her brothers had a nice time sliding on it.

Clara was sorry when it got to be twelve o'clock, and it was time to go home. The sledge was piled up with boughs, and the oxen wanted their dinner. Yes, they must go.

But when Clara was nestled in her little bed that night, and had said her prayers, this was her thought, "Oh, I never shall forget this happy, happy day; the bright, bracing air, so sweet and clear; the mild, soft sunshine; the smell of the pines; the frolic on the pond; the ride on the sledge; the little snowbirds that came in a flock when I began to feed them. Oh, I never shall forget it; no, never, never-r-r, nev—;" And with this last word half uttered, my little niece fell asleep.

EMILY CARTER.



THE BASKET OF APPLES.

I.

ALBERT is a bright little fellow. He is not three years old; but he can read ten words in "The Nursery." These words are, cat, dog, cow, horse, bird, mother, father, brother, sister, apple.

One day, John the gardener left a basket of apples at the top of the garden-steps. Albert saw it, and knew it was meant for the house. "I will take it in," said he. "I am strong."



II.

But the basket was not so light as he had thought. Indeed it was quite heavy. Perhaps this was because it was full of apples. The gardener had just picked them from a fine old tree in the orchard.

Albert was a stout little fellow; but the basket was too much for him. In trying to lift it, he upset it; and some of the apples rolled out down the steps as fast as they could go. Perhaps they saw it was a good chance to run away.



III.

Albert did not cry. He knew that crying would do no good. What was now the first thing to be done? Albert thought for a while, and said to himself, "The first thing to do is to set the basket upright."

He did not find it hard work to do this. All the apples had not run out. Some were still in the basket.

Albert picked up one, smelt of it, and then put it back. He next placed the basket upright.



IV.

Having done this so that the basket stood firm, he said, "What is the next thing to do? The next thing to do is to put back the apples; and I am the boy that can do it."

And he did it well. He did not once think of keeping any of the apples for himself; nor did he even take a bite of one of them. He was a good boy, and too honest for that.

If any one had said to him, "Give me an apple," Albert would have said, "The apples are not mine to give."



V.

"Now it is all right again," said Albert. "What next? If the basket will not let me carry it, the basket shall carry me. That would be fair play."

So he mounted the basket, as you see, took hold of the handle with his left hand, and cried out, "Get up, sir!" He made believe it was a horse. "Get up, sir!" he cried. But the horse would not move.



VI.

Albert then began to shake the basket, as if to urge it on. Ah, me! who would have thought to see it play the gay horse in earnest? It seemed so gentle!

Who would have thought to see it shy, and kick up, and throw Albert off? But so it did. Albert put out both hands to save himself, but he could not keep his seat. Over he went.



VII.

Over went the basket. Albert, apples, and all rolled down the steps. "Help!" he cried. The gardener ran up to see what was the matter.

"Where are my apples?" said he. "Here!" said Albert, jumping up, for the lucky rogue was not hurt a bit.

UNCLE SAM.



CHRISTMAS.

Words by ALFRED SELWYN.[\[A\]](#)

Music by T. CRAMPTON.

f Bold and lively.

1. Christmas is com- ing, ho, ho, and ho, ho! Now bring on your hol- ly and
do not move slow; We'll deck the whole house with the branches so green, On
wall and on pic- ture the leaves shall be seen. Oh! mer- ry the time when we
all meet to - geth- er In spite of the cold, the wind, and the wea- ther, When
grandparents, uncles, and cousins we see, All gather'd around the mahog- a- ny tree.

[Transcriber's Note: You can play this music (MIDI file) by clicking [here](#) and a larger image of the music sheet may be seen by clicking on the image.]

Christmas is coming, ho, ho, and ho, ho!
Now bring on your holly and do not move slow;
We'll deck the whole house with the branches so
green,
On wall and on picture the leaves shall be seen.
Oh! merry the time when we all meet together
In spite of the cold, the wind, and the weather,
When grandparents, uncles, and cousins we see,
All gather'd around the mahogany tree.

2.

It stands in the hall, the mahogany tree;
And very nice fruit it will bear, you'll agree;
The turkeys and capons, the puddings and pies,
On Christmas day feed something more than the
eyes.
The poor and the needy then come to our door,
And carry off with them a bountiful store
Of all the good things that we have for ourselves,
In cupboard and cellar, on table and shelves.

3.

When dinner is ended, what sound do we hear
From holly-deck'd parlor ring merry and clear?
'Tis Uncle Tom's fiddle! the tune is a call
To all the good people to come to our ball.
They come, young and old, and partake of our
cheer,
For old Christmas comes only once in a year!
Then hand up the holly, and let us prepare
The house for the pleasure in which all can share.

FOOTNOTE:

[\[A\]](#) Nursery, Vol. XXIV.

Transcriber's Notes:

Obvious punctuation errors repaired.

The original text for the January issue had a table of contents that spanned six issues. This was divided amongst those issues.

Additionally, only the January issue had a title page. This page was copied for the remaining five issues. Each issue had the number added on the title page after the Volume number.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE NURSERY,
JANUARY 1881, VOL. XXIX ***

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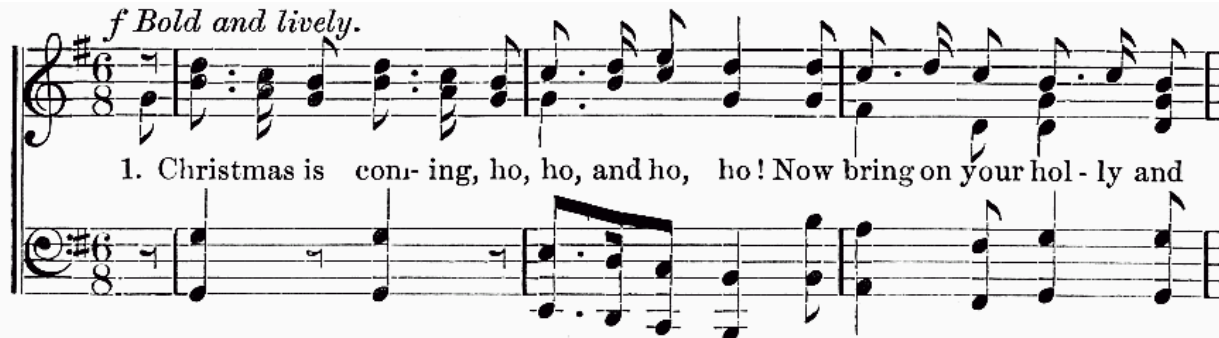
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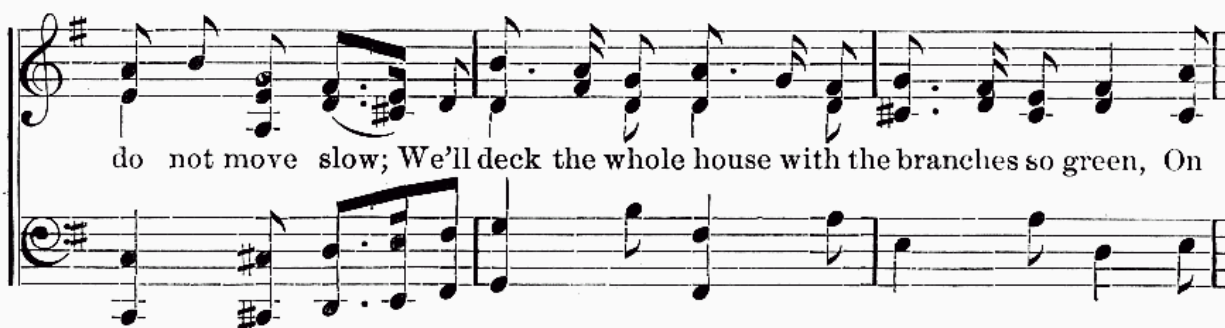
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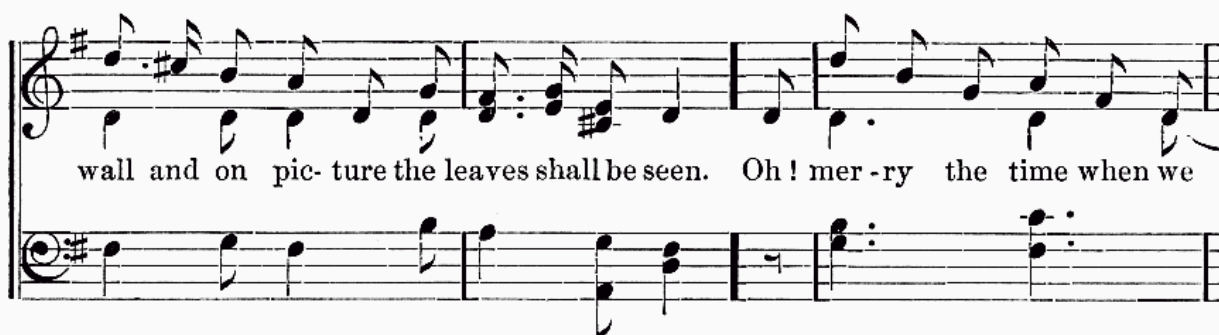
1. Christmas is com- ing, ho, ho, and ho, ho! Now bring on your hol- ly and

The first system of the musical score is written for a piano. It features a treble and bass staff in G major (one sharp) and 6/8 time. The melody is lively and rhythmic, with many eighth and sixteenth notes. The lyrics are printed below the treble staff.



do not move slow; We'll deck the whole house with the branches so green, On

The second system continues the melody and accompaniment. The lyrics "do not move slow; We'll deck the whole house with the branches so green, On" are printed below the treble staff.



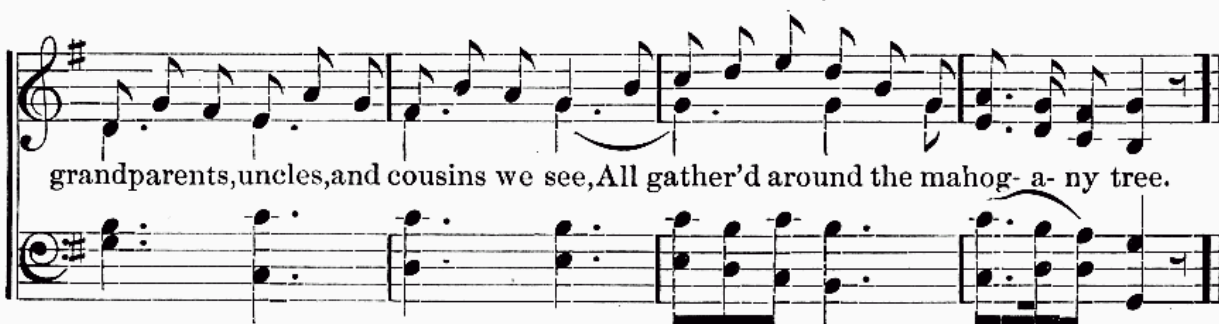
wall and on pic- ture the leaves shall be seen. Oh! mer- ry the time when we

The third system continues the melody and accompaniment. The lyrics "wall and on pic- ture the leaves shall be seen. Oh! mer- ry the time when we" are printed below the treble staff.



all meet to - geth- er In spite of the cold, the wind, and the wea- ther, When

The fourth system continues the melody and accompaniment. The lyrics "all meet to - geth- er In spite of the cold, the wind, and the wea- ther, When" are printed below the treble staff.



grandparents, uncles, and cousins we see, All gather'd around the mahog- a- ny tree.

The fifth system concludes the melody and accompaniment. The lyrics "grandparents, uncles, and cousins we see, All gather'd around the mahog- a- ny tree." are printed below the treble staff.

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